Game concept

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Introduction

In this presentation I will be explaining the game idea that is currently in the concept stage, which is called “The Untold of Coruscant”. Which is a game idea which I came up with on the Star Wars universe, that will feature a story of a main protagonist going through the struggles of crime and poverty, not seen in any of the famous Star Wars movies or even other video games. So, this makes the setting of the game within the Star Wars universe, during the Galactic Empire, where Coruscant is never mentioned within the movies during the specific era.

The game idea that has been created will be a Single player, 3rd person, open 3D world, story based game which is planned for PC, PS4 and Xbox One. The game focuses around the dark and gritty life of a young woman within the slums of the underworld in the city planet of Coruscant, plagued by poverty and crime.

This game will be designed and developed for the PC, PS4 and Xbox One systems, due to the hardware requirements of a game of this calibre, because of it’s open world genre on a 3D world. Also, these platforms offer a much wider variety of input and output devices, which can be used for a more immersive experience or for a specialist purpose for those found with disabilities.

The perspective of the game will be a 3rd person view on a 3D world which is very accessible to the player, hence it falling under the open world genre. A 3rd person view on a 3D world was picked because I felt that it would fit a game which is a story based open world action shooter, since other games on the market under the same genes also use 3rd person view on a 3D world.

So, it brings on a sense of familiarity and tradition to the genre of the game, and that a 3rd person view is also much easier to see the main protagonists emotions and body language, which could be considered important for a story based game. Also, I believe that it is much easier to play an open world game on 3rd person instead of 1st person, through personal experience of the use of other open world games that include both features.

Unit 40: P2, M2, D2

For the target audience, my game wouldn’t be targeted at a specific group of people, gender or race. Instead, it would be targeted at people who enjoy playing a story based, open world action 3rd person shooter, but there are some scenes planned for the game considered to be extremely graphic.

For example, the fights that take place in the game, with all the different high tech weapons available, can be graphic due to the untrained but brutal combat style of criminals and gang members found through the game. Also, the fighting, killing, stealth and overall action is something that will typically attract males to the game, but with a female protagonist and a heavy storyline, I could only hope that it would bring a more variety of players to the game.

The reason I have picked a female protagonist for a game like this is because there isn’t a lot of female protagonists found in video games, especially ones with this type of genre. So, I felt by adding a female as a playable character, it would be a breath of fresh air for the players and would bring an interesting perspective for the player, which would hopefully get the game more attention.

Due to the dark and gritty theme of the game, it would most likely be rated at PEGI 18. However, that doesn’t still exclude the purchase of the game by a younger audience, as statistics show, meaning that it is possible that my game will possibly catch the attention of males and females on their mid/late teens to adults.

However, the storyline of "A female protagonist taking the role of a cold blooded criminal" is something that could cause some controversy for the target audience, especially with some of the male players to the game, due to some possibility of misunderstanding and imagining it as some sort of subliminal message.

Overall, I believe The Untold of Coruscant has little room for everybody with its cinematic story line, since the target audience isn’t a very specific target. Due to the fact I want to try and get everyone to enjoy the planned game, but that’s if it falls within their personal taste. Especially for those who don’t mind seeing extreme violence, bad language, use of drugs and mild sexual content.

Inspiration

The inspiration towards this game idea comes heavily from the well known “Star Wars” Franchise, hence the setting of the game. I first got the inspiration after my fascination with the “Cyberpunk” genre of movies and novels, due to the interesting aspect of “high tech and low life” aspect of the genre. Which made me realise that this such genre could fit well with sci-fi movies and games such as Star Wars, which lead me to find out about the underworld section of the planet Coruscant, which I believed to be a perfect cyberpunk setting.

The genre of my game is equal that to well known open world games, such as Rockstar’s Grand Theft Auto franchise and the Mafia franchise by 2K Games. The reason being that the game follows the pattern of many Rockstar and 2K Games titles, it has open world aspects, contains a story and can fall under the genre of action games.

Of course, the planned world isn't as versatile as some Rockstar or 2K Games world, due to the fact the player is constantly within the underground, but it follows the same gameplay and characterisation style of the games. Due to the fact they all fall under the 3rd person open world action shooter genre and they all focus on the violent and disturbing lives of criminals.

However, even though The Untold of Coruscant is a story based 3rd person open world game, it also has hints of different types of genres in it. One example is Stealth, the Stealth part of the game is crucial when it comes to sneaking past hostiles, such as police officers, when in high notoriety or in a restricted area. As well as the hostile gang members, that are just a big a problem if the player is caught where they shouldn't be.

Overall, there were many factors which inspired me to come up with this game concept, most of which came from the things I personally found interesting and would like to see in a video game. Those factors being the cyberpunk genre, the Star Wars franchise, my love for story games, open world games and violent action and shooter games.

Game-world

The game world is heavily inspired by the fictional planet “Coruscant” from the famous “Star Wars” franchise, which is the main setting to the video game. However, there are further plans for the game that there will be other locations which are also inspired by “Star Wars” planets and systems. Coruscant’s underworld will be the main and initial setting to the video game, which is the surface of the city planet’s towering skyscrapers found in a few of the Star Wars movies. The game environment has a gritty and cyberpunk feel to it, due to the high tech but low living standards that are found with the underworld. Which makes it a fitting place for crime, violence and an overall immoral lifestyle found in many of the characters for the game.

The terrain of the game will be the movable terrain which the player will be moving around in. The terrain will consist mostly of streets due to the setting of the game being in the surface of a planet that is one big city, so the terrain itself won't have much variety towards the player, but it can be made so it wouldn’t feel like the same street all over the map.

Since the game falls under the open world genre of games, it is important to include a significant amount of terrain acceptable to the player. Not only that, but the terrain must blend in well with the other aspects of the game, such as the architecture and the objects found throughout the game world. This is so the player doesn’t feel like anything is misplaced, which can make the game experience less excitable and immersive for some players.

The architecture of the game is a very important aspect to a game like this, since it is set within a city. So, the inclusion of buildings in a game like this would be in a very large scale, which can make some hardware run the game poorly due to the amount of objects on screen. Which is why I have chosen PC and consoles as the platform for this video game. However, high rise buildings will be the only architecture found within the game, since it is what makes up the planet Coruscant, so no plants or other non-movable/non-destructible objects would only be found as objects, as decorations for apartments.

The Objects of the game would consist of interactable objects such as weapons, vehicles, equipment, stores and even destructible objects such as wooden crates or steel bins. The interaction with objects in a game like this is important, because games under this genre rely on interaction to make the player feel like they are interacting with the world around them, especially when interacting with vehicles and stores.

Characters (Player controlled)

The main protagonist to the game is the player controlled character named Alisia, a female character grown up within the slums of the underworld. Making her very aggressive, assertive and unsympathetic, which the player will assume it's due to the constant crime and killing making her desensitised.

However, what makes Alisia such a cold blooded killer from the beginning of the game, is his lack of fear to death, which would be noticeable for the player when they realise that she develops an aimless deathwish after coming out of her coma, that gave her a certain loss of memory which most likely was significant part to her. This is what makes Alisia initially unsympathetic towards crime and killing.

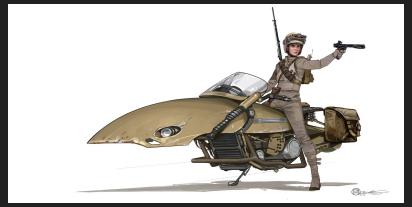
Planned for the initial story, Alisia's personality is extremely vague, due to her lack of talking, mystery and the constantly-changing conditions in her appartment. Her exact age is unknown, due to the fact no one will mention much about it, although it is noticeable that she might be in her late 20s or early 30s.

Although, throughout the story she is impacted by significant events with her loved ones and the people she has close relations, and starts developing feelings of sympathy, regret and grief. As these feelings develop, she will start questioning why she carries out crimes.

This will make the player understand the hardships of not only Alisia's life, but the lives of many which have been forced into crime through the low life but high tech environment of the underworld. Hopefully making the player sympathise emotionally with the character as the game progresses.



Alisia character concept art



Alisia's speeder ("Whirlwind") and her blaster ("The Persuader") concept art

Characters (NPCs and environmental)

The other non-player characters will have heavy influence from the Star Wars franchise, no matter if it is canon or works of fan fiction, what matters is to make sure that they blend in well with the setting of the game, making it feel genuine to the player. The NPCs are in the game to make it seem more alive, therefore more immersive to the Star Wars universe, featuring many different races and species found in the Star Wars lore.

The friendly NPCs will be implemented into the game as the main protagonist's friends and close ones, which will be heavily implemented within the story. While other friendly NPCs will just be used for assitance for combat, to make the combat within the game feel more alive to the player.

The hostile NPCs can come in many forms, ranging from a thug working for an organised crime group to a heavily armed Coruscant Underworld Police officer. The type of enemies the player may come across in the game will depend on the area the player is in, the mission currently active and the area of the map the player is on.

The neutral NPCs are there to make the game feel like it is alive and that the player is in a real city. However, there will be some neutral NPCs within the game that can be interacted with, to get extra side missions, mini games, blueprints for certain weapons or equipment or even as some backup help with some missions, as friendly NPCs.









Mood board













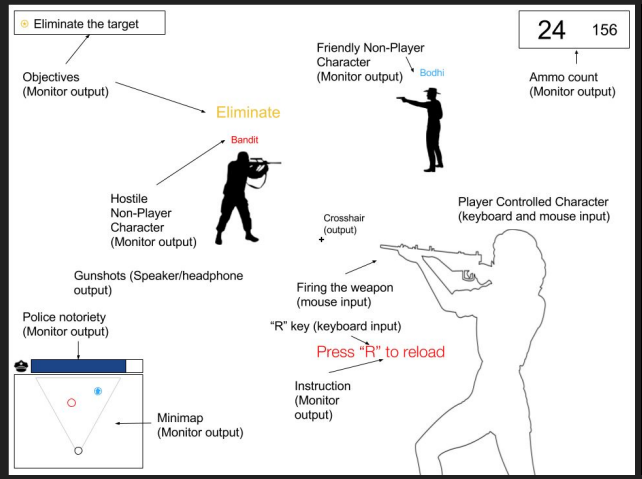




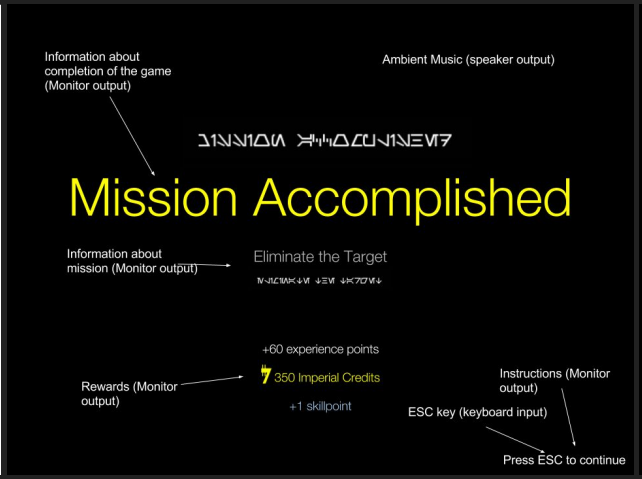


Interface designs

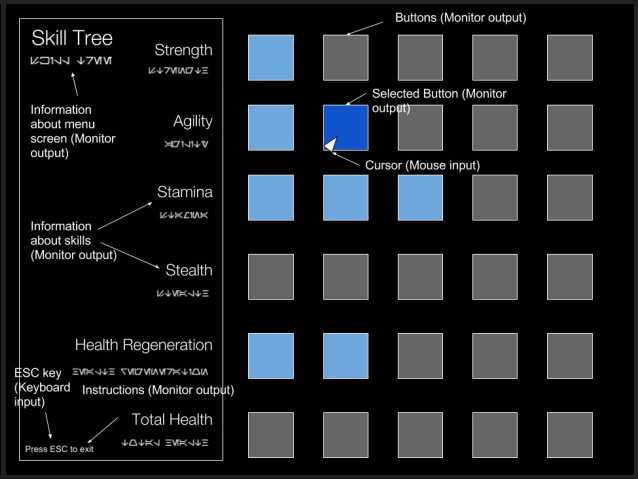
While I was creating the Interface designs, I considered the important HCI standards of perspective, which is proximity (Which is the distance between each object), continuity (Which is a repetitive flow of a specific design), symmetry (Which is when an image is similar on both sides), similarity (Which is objects or images sharing the same colour or dimensions, but perform different actions) and connectedness (Which is the connectivity of images, making the player realise that they have some sort of connection). With the examples below, the interface design for the game will be a simplistic but informatic display, showing the player the essentials needed to carry out objectives, navigate and assist with gameplay aspects such as firing a weapon and interacting with objects. The reason that interface will be simplistic is due to the fact it doesn't stand out to the player that much and it doesn't clutter the screen, so the player wouldn't be distracted by the UI and play the game comfortably, while still having information visible.



Gameplay User Interface



Mission completed User Interface



Skill tree User Interface

Interface designs

As seen with the examples, the user interfaces have been designed to give the player a good amount of information without significant amount of confusion that would throw a player off and the UI has also been aesthetically designed to fit the theme of the game. With the Gameplay UI, it is a simplistic design, but it could be considered more advanced than other games. Due to the fact it includes a mini map, how much ammo the weapon has and the objective screen, showing the player what they currently have to do.

It also shows the player where the player is aiming (with the crosshair), which NPC is hostile of friendly (With use of the minimap or colour coding the names on-screen). It even shows the location of nearby NPCs on the minimap, indicating where they are from the player's perspective and whether they are above or below grown with use of an arrow on the NPC's circle.

However, there are other planned aspects to the UI such as a weapon wheel (Giving the player the ability to switch weapons faster) and access to the inventory (Using items such as currency, ammunition and other utilities.). This is so the player can access the essentials for the game with a good understanding on how to access and the progression of the game.

With the Mission completed screen, it is a very simplified design, showing either if the mission is completed or failed, what mission has been completed and the rewards the player got from completing said mission. Giving the player a sense of completion and understanding with the progression of the game.

With the skill tree, again is very simplistic, making the player understand the interface much easier and without a lot of confusion. It shows every skill, with a planned information screen showing what each of the skills do, so the player understands what they are using. Also, with the use of illumination, the player would comprehend which skill that they spent a skillpoint in, by going from a dim grey to a bright blue.

Input/Output/Device

The game will have optimisation for a wide variety of input and output devices, which gives it the ability to be more immersive and to fit the needs of players who have certain disabilities, such as colour blindness or limited hand movements, or different abilities, such as being left handed. Meaning that specialist devices are required to replace traditional interaction devices for those in need.

For the PC, there are a variety of input and output devices that can be used for this game, which can make the game more immersive and accessible for those with disabilities, increasing the target audience of the game. However, for consoles, there isn't much of a variety of input and output devices that can be used, let alone for a game of this genre.

PC Input devices such as keyboard and mouse are very mainstream, but can come in many shapes and sizes, suiting the ergonomics of the individual player, which fits under Guiard's model, which states that not all input methods are for everyone. However, a controller can also be used to play games on the PC, but since this game also supports console, it wouldn't be a problem using the controller on the PC due to the game's planned optimisation towards controllers.

The most mainstream input device for a console is the controller, which is widely used by many console manufacturers due to the comfort and familiarity of a controler. Since the input keys on a controller are significantly less than that on a keyboard, it means that the keys need to fit the needs of the controller in order to have full access to the game's controls, meaning that the keyboard and mouse on a PC would have to contain a lot less keys due to console optimisation.

PC Output devices such as monitors are very mainstream output devices, with a simple display made up of thousands of pixels, manipulating colour to give an illusion towards the viewer. However, there are other output devices which can also be implemented to this game, such as a virtual reality headset and sound outputs like speakers or headphones. The output device for a console is the TV or monitor that it is connected to, similar that to a PC. However, not all consoles are connected to a sound output device, such as a speaker or headphones, because the TV may already have built in speakers.

Unit 23: P3, M2

When I have researched about these input and output methods and devices, I decided to start on the user interface design. On which I have implemented a form of Key Action Model, which gives the player instructions on how to interact with objects and actions within the game.

For instance, including a KAM such as“Press “R” to reload” or a “Press “F” to enter the vehicle”, would benefit the player a lot because it gives an output of instructions through the monitor or VR headset, on which the player will comprehend the instruction and input the key on the keyboard to execute the command.

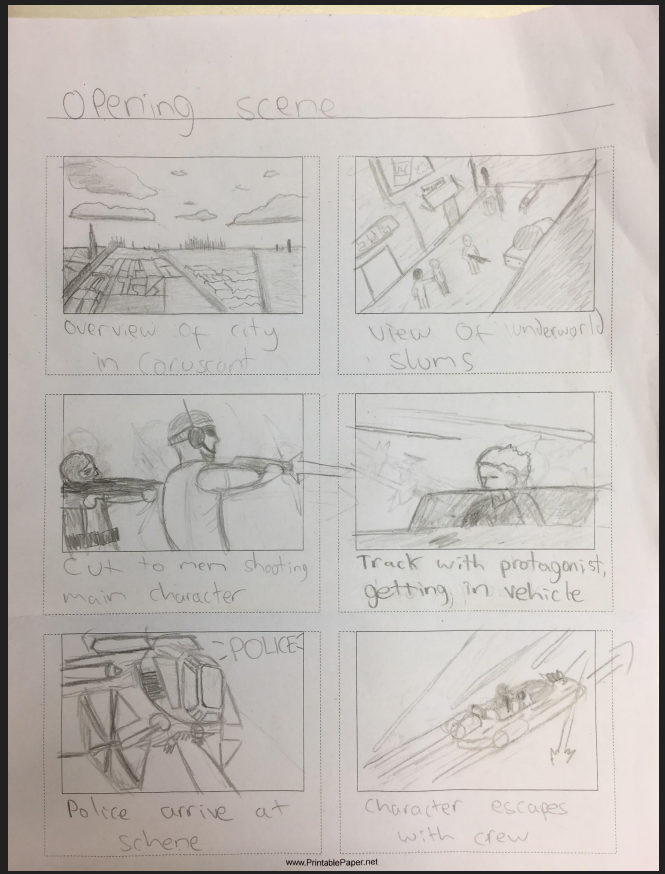
Sound can also be used as an output device instead of only a monitor, which is a great advantage for games due to the emotional manipulation that sound can bring. Within the game, there can be certain interaction that can trigger a sound indicating the player that the item has been interacted with. For example, if the player clicks Mouse 1/Right bumper, the weapon will fire and the player will hear the gunshot, knowing that he had triggered the action. So, optimising my game for speakers would benefit a lot more than just optimising it for a single output device such as a TV/monitor.

Overall, I have realised how important it is to have a variety of input and output devices optimised for a game. With having different output devices such as a monitor and speaker optimised for the game, the player will not only be immersed with the graphical and audial aspect of the game, but will also help with the human computer interaction with the game. Giving visual instruction and audial signals to the player, showing the player how to interact with the object and whether the player has actually interacted with the object or not.

With having different input devices, such as a keyboard, mouse and a controller optimised for the game, can have its advantages and disadvantages. What I mean by that is, by having a larger variety of input devices, the players of the game can have different and more comfortable experiences with the game, especially if the game has an option to change the key bindings.

However, the disadvantage to having different input devices, means that the game is optimized to fit the needs of all the devices. Meaning that the keyboard would have a lot less key bindings in order to carry out different actions due to the larger amount of buttons, but some people may see this as an advantage because it reduces complexity.

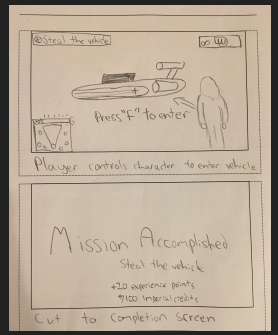
Storyboard with goals and challenges



This is the storyboard which depicts the opening scene to the game, giving the player the cinematic feel to the video game. This is so it makes the player realise that it will be a story based game, and that it will include cutscenes to show important parts to the story. Hence the game being story based, the goals and challenged in the game come in the form of missions. Such as story missions, side missions and other mini games planned throughout the game.

The main goal and challenge of the game is to complete the story to learn more about the character and the game itself, making the player notice with the Mission completed screen previously mentioned. Which shows the rewards that the player got for the completion of the mission. Also, the game will also get progressively more difficult, adding to that challenge.

Goals and challenges also do apply to side missions and mini games, but does not progress the player throughout the game, instead giving extra experience for skill points and credits for purchasing in game items. So, the goal with these missions is for rewards and experience.



On the left is an example of what the player would see when a goal is completed, which is a mission in this game. It shows the rewards the player has received and shows that the part of the game has been completed.

However, The game doesn't have a leveling system, instead having experience points to build up skills points, which are used to enhance the character's abilities.